

CHLORHEXIDINE

_____Name
_____Date

also called... Hibiclens, Avagard, Betasept, Biopatch, ChloraPrep, Chlorostat, Clorexil, Dexidin, Dyna-Hex, Exidine, Hibiscrub, Hibistat, Oronine, Operand, Perichlor, Peridex, Periochip, and Periogard.

What is it?

Chlorhexidine (as **digluconate**, **acetate**, **diacetate**, or **dihydrochloride**) is an antibacterial compound used mainly in cleansers and disinfectants. Sometimes it is added to cosmetics and toiletries as a preservative.

Where might it be found?

Moisturizer, hand cream
Facial cleanser
Acne cleanser, remedy
Eye make-up remover
Moistened towelettes
Facial toner, face balm
Aftershave moisturizer
Eye cream, night cream
Anti-wrinkle cream
Shampoo
Hair conditioner, gel
Hair relaxer, spray
Hair color, bleach
Mascara
Eye drops, rewetting
Contact lens solution
Nose spray
Toothpaste
Mouthwash
Tooth gum treatment
Hand cleanser
Personal lubricant
Burn or ulcer cleanser
Surgical scrub
Urologic disinfectant
Gynecological prep
Diaper area cleanser
Oral surgical prep
Household antiseptic
Household cleaner
Dog oral rinse
Pet dental care
Dairy cow teat care
Some topical medicines

NOTE: In some people, contact with chlorhexidine causes hives, shortness of breath, and blood pressure drop, called anaphylactic shock.

How to avoid it:

Avoid using any product containing chlorhexidine. Check the label of everything you use to find the complete ingredient list. If chlorhexidine is present, one of its names should appear in the ingredients. If no ingredient list is present, go to the store and inspect the original box or package. Some products' ingredient lists are available on the internet at the manufacturer's website, the store's website, or websites such as <http://householdproducts.nlm.nih.gov>, <http://www.cosmeticsdatabase.com>, or <http://www.drugstore.com>.

For possible workplace exposure, check the complete ingredient list of all solutions and products encountered. If you must come in contact with chlorhexidine at work or as you care for others, wear protective gloves made of rubber, nitrile, or vinyl.

Ask your doctor to check the ingredients of any medications prescribed for use on your skin to be sure no chlorhexidine is present. Ask your nurse, surgeon, doctor, dentist, dental hygienist, barber, hairdresser, aesthetician, masseuse, and attendant to avoid using chlorhexidine-containing products in your care.

These measures should help you avoid this allergen. By reading ingredient labels, you should be able to find safe alternatives that are free of it.